

Host-listener dialogue (Topic: Zeigarnik effect)

Host: Listener:

大家好，欢迎收听今天的节目。你有没有过这样的经历：明明一件事还没做完，却怎么也忘不了它？嗯，这背后其实有个超有趣的心理学现象，叫做蔡格尼克效应。听上去是不是有点神秘？但它其实跟我们日常生活息息相关，特别是在设计和学习上有大用处。

Hello everyone, and welcome to today's podcast. Have you ever had this experience: a task isn't finished yet, and you just can't stop thinking about it? Behind that is a fascinating psychological phenomenon called the Zeigarnik effect. It may sound a little mysterious, but it is closely related to everyday life—especially in design and learning, where it can be very useful.

哇，蔡格尼克效应？这名字听起来挺复杂的。能不能先简单介绍一下，到底是什么东西？

Wow, the Zeigarnik effect? The name sounds a bit complicated. Could you briefly explain what it actually is?

当然可以。简单来说，蔡格尼克效应指的是我们对未完成任务的记忆更深刻，而对已经完成任务的记忆反而淡了。换句话说，就是‘做事有始有终’的内驱力，让我们对没做完的事情念念不忘。

Of course. Simply put, the Zeigarnik effect means that we remember unfinished tasks more vividly than completed ones. In other words, the drive to bring things to completion keeps unfinished tasks on our minds.

等一下，真的？那就是说，如果我正在写一篇文章，中途停了，那我会更记得这篇文章的内容吗？

Wait, really? So if I'm writing an article and stop halfway, does that mean I'll remember the article better?

没错！这就是蔡格尼克效应的魅力所在。它最早是由前苏联心理学家布卢玛·蔡格尼克发现的。她做了个实验，让参与者做一系列简单任务，比如写喜欢的诗，倒数数字什么的。

Exactly. That is the appeal of the Zeigarnik effect. It was first discovered by the Soviet psychologist Bluma Zeigarnik. She conducted an experiment in which participants were asked to complete a series of simple tasks, such as writing down a favorite poem or counting backward.

嗯嗯，听起来挺普通的实验，结果呢？

Mm-hmm, that sounds like a fairly ordinary experiment. What happened?

结果非常有意思。参与者对那些被中断的任务记忆率高达 68%，而对完成的任务只有 43%。这说明未完成的任务在记忆中更活跃。

The results were very interesting. Participants remembered as many as 68% of the interrupted tasks, compared with only 43% of the completed tasks. This suggests that unfinished tasks remain more active in memory.

哇，差这么多！那为什么会这样？心理学上有什么解释吗？

Wow, that is quite a difference. Why does this happen? Is there a psychological explanation?

有的。勒温的场论给出了一个解释：当我们开始一个任务时，会产生一种心理紧张状态，这种紧张会驱使我们完成任务。任务完成后，这种紧张缓解；但如果任务被中断，这种紧张依然存在，促使我们不断回想未完成的任务。

Yes. Lewin's field theory offers one explanation: when we start a task, a state of psychological tension is created, and this tension drives us to complete the task. Once the task is completed, the tension is relieved; but if the task is interrupted, the tension remains, prompting us to keep thinking about the unfinished task.

嗯，听起来像是内心有个小闹钟不停提醒你‘嘿，别忘了没做完的事’。那这心理紧张不会让人很焦虑吗？

That sounds like having a little alarm clock inside your mind constantly reminding you, "Hey, don't forget what you haven't finished." But wouldn't this psychological tension make people anxious?

确实，心理紧张有时会带来压力，但适度的紧张其实是动力来源。它激发了我们的记忆和认知，让我们更专注于未完成的任务。

Indeed, psychological tension can sometimes create pressure, but a moderate level of tension can also be a source of motivation. It activates our memory and cognition, helping us focus more on unfinished tasks.

那是不是每个人都会有这种效应？还是说不同人表现不同？

Does everyone experience this effect? Or does it vary from person to person?

好问题！后续研究发现，蔡格尼克效应的强度会受到任务性质、个体心理特征和成就动机水平的影响。比如，高成就动机的人可能更容易被未完成任务驱动。

Good question. Later studies found that the strength of the Zeigarnik effect can be influenced by task characteristics, individual psychological traits, and levels of achievement motivation. For example, people with high achievement motivation may be more easily driven by unfinished tasks.

嗯，那这效应能不能被用来设计产品？比如 App 或游戏？我觉得这种‘没做完的东西更让人念念不忘’很有用。

So, can this effect be used in product design, such as apps or games? I think this idea that “unfinished things stay on our minds” could be very useful.

完全正确！这就是蔡格尼克效应在设计中的巨大价值。设计师可以利用它来提升用户参与度和粘性。比如，进度条就是典型应用。它让用户看到任务还没完成，激发他们想完成的内驱力。

Absolutely. This is exactly where the Zeigarnik effect has great value in design. Designers can use it to increase user engagement and stickiness. For example, progress bars are a typical application. They show users that a task is not yet complete, which stimulates their inner drive to finish it.

哦，进度条我懂！就像游戏里的任务进度，看到没满的进度条就想赶紧完成对吧？

Oh, I get progress bars. It is like task progress in games: when you see that the progress bar is not full, you want to complete it quickly, right?

对，没错。还有连续签到功能、学习 App 的章节解锁，都是用这个原理让用户持续参与。

Yes, exactly. Features such as daily check-ins and chapter unlocking in learning apps also use this principle to keep users engaged.

那有没有什么反面例子？我听说社交媒体的无限滚动会让人上瘾，是不是也跟这个有关？

Are there any negative examples? I heard that infinite scrolling on social media can be addictive. Is that related to this effect too?

非常敏锐！无限滚动制造了一种‘永远未完成’的体验，持续激活蔡格尼克效应，导致用户难以停下来，容易沉迷和浪费时间。

Very perceptive. Infinite scrolling creates an “always unfinished” experience, continuously activating the Zeigarnik effect. As a result, users may find it hard to stop, making them more likely to become absorbed and waste time.

哇，原来背后有这么深的心理机制。那在学习上，蔡格尼克效应怎么帮忙呢？比如我用学习 App 的时候。

Wow, I didn't realize there was such a deep psychological mechanism behind it. How can the Zeigarnik effect help with learning, for example when I use a learning app?

学习中，适当的中断反而能增强记忆效果。比如把课程分成模块，完成一个模块后提示‘你已解锁下一章’，既给用户完成感，又激发继续学习的动力。

In learning, appropriate interruptions can actually enhance memory. For example, dividing a course into modules and showing a prompt such as “You have unlocked the next chapter” after one module is completed gives users a sense of completion while also motivating them to continue learning.

嗯，这样分阶段学习，感觉更有成就感，也更容易坚持。那在工作和项目管理里呢？有没有应用？

Yes, learning in stages like that feels more rewarding and easier to stick with. What about work and project management? Are there applications there?

当然！现代项目管理工具如 Todoist、Trello 就是基于这个效应设计的。未完成任务自然激发用户去清理和完成它们。现在甚至有 AI 助手，能帮用户排序和提醒，提升效率。

Of course. Modern project management tools such as Todoist and Trello are designed around this effect. Unfinished tasks naturally motivate users to clear and complete them. Today, there are even AI assistants that can help users prioritize tasks and send reminders, improving efficiency.

哇，AI 还能这么智能地理解任务上下文，帮忙管理未完成任务，真是太酷了。

Wow, AI can intelligently understand task contexts and help manage unfinished tasks. That is really cool.

是啊，蔡格尼克效应不仅仅是心理学现象，更是连接认知与技术的桥梁。

Yes. The Zeigarnik effect is not only a psychological phenomenon, but also a bridge between cognition and technology.

总结一下，蔡格尼克效应就是我们对未完成任务记忆更深，心理紧张驱使我们完成它。设计师和产品经理可以利用这一点提高用户粘性和体验，对吗？

To sum up, the Zeigarnik effect means that we remember unfinished tasks more vividly, and psychological tension drives us to complete them. Designers and product managers can use this to improve user stickiness and user experience, right?

完全正确。它帮助我们理解行为持续性，也提醒我们要合理管理‘未完成’的状态，避免负面影响。

Exactly. It helps us understand behavioral persistence and also reminds us to manage “unfinished” states properly to avoid negative effects.

嗯，这真是个实用又有趣的心理学效应！感谢你的分享，让我对日常生活和工作都有了新的理解。

This really is a practical and interesting psychological effect. Thank you for sharing it. It gives me a new understanding of everyday life and work.

不客气！希望大家也能用好蔡格尼克效应，让生活和工作都更高效。我们下期节目再见！

You're welcome. I hope everyone can make good use of the Zeigarnik effect to make life and work more efficient. See you in the next podcast!